

The Banker's Before-You-Paste AI Safety Checklist

A print-ready Safe AI Use Checklist for any banker about to put work into an AI tool. The checklist is informed by current banking model-risk, third-party risk, fair-lending, and financial-sector AI governance resources.

One-page operating checklist

Use this page at the desk, in a team huddle, or as the cover sheet for an internal AI-use standard. AI output is draft work until a qualified human reviews it.

- ☐ **Customer identifiers removed.** Names, account numbers, balances, transaction details, Social Security numbers, addresses, and dates of birth are out.
- ☐ **Confidential records removed.** Examiner correspondence, internal reports, vendor contracts, and non-public bank records are not pasted into public tools.
- ☐ **Prompt asks for a draft, not a decision.** The AI may summarize, structure, or suggest options; it may not approve, deny, classify, or decide.
- ☐ **Output marked for human review.** Numbers, dates, citations, policy claims, and procedural steps are checked against source documents.
- ☐ **Credit, legal, privacy, complaint, or customer-impacting use escalated.** When in doubt, route through compliance, fair lending, legal, privacy, or the approved AI review path.

1 · Strip sensitive data

- Replace real identifiers with [CUSTOMER], [ACCOUNT], [DATE], and [AMOUNT].
- If you would not email it outside the bank, do not paste it into a tool you do not control.

2 · Ask clearly

- Use CORE: give the context, the objective, the resources it may use, and your expectations for format and limits.
- Tell the AI what not to do, especially for regulated or customer-facing work.

3 • Fact-check outputs

- Mark uncertain content with [VERIFY].
- If the AI cites a rule or source, look it up before using it.

4 • Escalate risky decisions

- Use approved internal tools and workflows for sensitive work.
- Classify uncertain use cases as higher risk until reviewed.

Use this as a first control, not the whole policy.

This checklist is designed to support safe-use habits before a banker uses AI. Adapt it before adoption, route it through your institution's normal approval process, and replace any local procedure gaps before distribution. It is not legal advice.

Who should read this

Board / audit: documented governance posture. **Compliance:** first anchor while the fuller framework is built. **Department heads:** team meeting handout. **Frontline bankers:** the four moves to use every time.

What this is not

- Not a full AI policy, model-risk program, third-party lifecycle review, or vendor contract review.
- Not approval to use public AI tools with customer data, confidential bank records, or non-public supervisory information.
- Not approval to use AI for credit, legal, privacy, complaint, BSA/AML, or customer-impacting decisions without documented review.

Source notes

- Model risk: informed by SR 26-2 revised model risk management guidance, which supersedes SR 11-7 and SR 21-8. Apply model-risk discipline proportionate to the use case.
- Third-party risk: designed to support safe-use habits consistent with Interagency Third-Party Risk Management guidance; it is not a substitute for planning, due diligence, contracting, monitoring, or termination controls.
- Credit and customer impact: for credit-related or customer-impacting uses, route through fair-lending and compliance review under ECOA / Regulation B expectations.
- AI governance vocabulary: informed by the AIEOG AI Lexicon and the Financial Services AI Risk Management Framework published through Treasury, FBII, and FSSCC.
- Governance gap statistic: Gartner Peer Community data cited by Jack Henry indicates 55% of organizations had not yet implemented an AI governance framework.

Next click

Download the companion Red / Yellow / Green AI Use Card at AIBankingInstitute.com/resources, or take the AI readiness self-assessment at AIBankingInstitute.com/assessment.